BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #49 · VISION AND HEARING LOSS

"I'll end up completely dependent on others."

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Where it often comes from

Progressive vision or hearing loss raises a fear of losing independence completely. The fear can be worse than reality, and it can keep us from planning and using helpful tools.

What Scripture teaches

"Do not worry about your life" (Matthew 6:25). "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray." Many people with sight or hearing loss live independently with training and tools. Learning skills now, such as orientation and mobility training, assistive technology, and communication strategies, can preserve independence. And if you do need more help someday, you will still be valued and loved.

> *"Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you"* (Isaiah 46:4).

Also see

> "Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or drink; or about your body, what you will wear. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothes?" (Matthew 6:25).

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).

> "Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand" (Psalm 73:23).

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

Common self-statements

- I will lose all independence.
- I will be a burden.
- It will only get worse.
- I will not be able to cope.
- I will lose my home.
- I will be helpless.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I will be either fully independent or fully dependent.
- Fortune telling: Predicting total dependence.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that it will happen.
- Catastrophizing: Calling myself doomed to dependence.

Challenging questions

- What does my specialist say about my likely course?
- What training or tools could help me stay independent?

- What do I do well now?
- Whom can I talk to who has adapted?
- What does Scripture say about God carrying me?
- What can I plan today?

Truth summary

> I can learn skills and use tools that keep me independent for as long as possible, and plan wisely. If I need more help, God will carry me and people will love me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Trust
- Peace
- Elderly

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'll end up completely dependent on others"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll end up completely dependent on others." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does my specialist say about my likely course?
- ☐ What training or tools could help me stay independent?
- ☐ What do I do well now?
- ☐ Whom can I talk to who has adapted?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God carrying me?
- ☐ What can I plan today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ He cares for me.
- ☐ I do not worry about tomorrow.
- ☐ Skills and tools help.
- ☐ Planning is wise.
- ☐ I am valued either way.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Isaiah 46:4**
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."
- ☐ **Matthew 6:25**
  "Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat or drink; or about your body, what you will wear. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothes?"
- ☐ **1 Peter 5:7**
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Prepared and at peace: Each month, note one skill or plan you made.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 46:4 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will carry me to my old age.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Ask your specialist. Learn the likely course.
- [ ] Seek training. Orientation, mobility, or communication.
- [ ] Meet someone who adapted. Hear their story.
- [ ] Pray Isaiah 46:4. Receive God's promise.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll end up completely dependent on others": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Prepared and at peace
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll end up completely dependent on others.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear losing independence. Carry me, give me wise tools and teachers, and keep me at peace whatever comes. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.